

Word family: **heart / hearts / heartfelt / heartless / hearty / wholehearted / wholeheartedly**

Base word: heart

Plural: hearts

Related forms: heartfelt, heartless, hearty, wholehearted, wholeheartedly

Useful constructions/extensions: heart beats/races, heart rate, heart disease, heart of something, at heart, take something to heart, learn/know by heart, have your heart set on, lose heart, take heart, from the heart, with all your heart, break someone's heart, heart goes out to someone, have a change of heart, heart-to-heart, heartfelt, heartless, wholehearted

Part of speech: mainly noun (名詞) / related adjective and adverb forms (相關形容詞及副詞)

Your passage contains:

> “My **heart would race**, my mind would go blank, and I would start imagining the worst.”

Here, **heart** refers primarily to the **physical organ** whose beating becomes faster when you are nervous or frightened.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **my heart would race**

heart means the physical organ in your chest that pumps blood around your body.

The expression **heart races** means:

your heartbeat becomes noticeably fast, especially because of nervousness, fear, excitement, exercise, or strong emotion.

Meaning: The organ that pumps blood, especially referring here to its rapid beating during anxiety.

繁體中文: **心臟**; 這裡特別指因緊張而心跳明顯加快

中文翻譯:

> “My heart would race, my mind would go blank...”

「我會**心跳加速**, 腦袋一片空白.....」

So:

****heart = 心臟****

****my heart races = 我的心跳突然變得很快／我心跳加速****

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. ****heart = organ that pumps blood (心臟) — 心臟****

This is the literal core meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** The muscular organ in the chest that pumps blood through the body.

Practice 1 — Original

> “My ****heart**** would race.”

「我的****心跳會加速****。」

Practice 2

> “The ****heart**** pumps blood around the body.”

「****心臟****把血液泵送到全身。」

Practice 3

> “Exercise can strengthen the ****heart****.”

「運動可以增強****心臟****功能。」

****heart = 位於胸腔內、負責把血液泵送到全身的器官****

2. ****heart beats/races/pounds (心跳) — 心跳; 心臟快速跳動****

A very important collocational branch.

Practice 4

> “Her ****heart was beating**** quickly before the interview.”

「面試前她的**心跳得很快**。」

Practice 5

> “My **heart started pounding** when they called my name.”

「他們叫到我的名字時，我開始**心跳得很厲害**。」

Common:

* heart beats = 心臟跳動

* heart races = 心跳加速

* heart pounds = 心跳得很強烈

* heart skips a beat = 心跳彷彿漏了一拍

heart + beating expression = 描述心臟跳動速度／力度，尤其常反映緊張、恐懼、興奮或運動後反應

3. **heart rate (心率) — 心跳速率; 心率**

Practice 6

> “My **heart rate** increased before I went on stage.”

「我上台前**心率**上升了。」

Practice 7

> “The device measures your **heart rate**.”

「這個裝置會量度你的**心率**。」

heart rate = 心臟每分鐘跳動的次數

4. **heart condition/disease/problem (心臟疾病) — 心臟疾病; 心臟問題**

Practice 8

> “He is being treated for a **heart condition**.”

「他正在接受**心臟疾病**治療。」

Practice 9

> “Regular exercise may reduce the risk of **heart disease**.”

「定期運動可能降低患上**心臟病**的風險。」

heart + medical noun = 與心臟健康、疾病或功能有關

5. **heart = emotions/feelings (感情) — 內心; 感情**

This is one of the most important figurative meanings.

Meaning: A person's emotions, especially deep or sincere feelings.

Practice 10

> “She knew in her **heart** that she had made the right decision.”

「她**內心深處**知道自己作出了正確決定。」

Practice 11

> “His words touched my **heart**.”

「他的說話**打動了我的心／感情**。」

heart = 一個人的深層感情、情緒或內心感受

Here **heart** is not the physical organ.

6. **from the heart (真心地) — 發自內心; 真誠地**

Practice 12

> “Her speech came **from the heart**.”

「她的演講是**發自內心的**。」

Practice 13

> “I want to thank you ****from the bottom of my heart****.”

「我想****由衷／打從心底****感謝你。」

****from the heart** = 真心、真誠地表達, 而不是例行或虛假的******

7. ****heartfelt**(真誠的; 由衷的) — 由衷的; 真摯的******

A highly useful related adjective.

Practice 14

> “She offered her ****heartfelt thanks**** to the team.”

「她向團隊表達了****由衷的感謝****。」

Practice 15

> “Please accept my ****heartfelt congratulations****.”

「請接受我****真誠的祝賀****。」

****heartfelt** = 感情真實而強烈、發自內心的******

Common:

- * heartfelt thanks
- * heartfelt apology
- * heartfelt congratulations
- * heartfelt sympathy

8. ****with all your heart**(全心全意) — 全心全意地; 真心地******

Practice 16

> “She wanted ****with all her heart**** to succeed.”

「她****全心全意／非常真心地****希望成功。」

Practice 17

> “I believe **with all my heart** that we can do it.”

「我**打從心底相信**我們做得到。」

with all your heart = 帶著非常強烈而真誠的感情／意願

9. **wholehearted / wholeheartedly** (全心全意／地) — 全心全意的; 毫無保留的

Practice 18

> “She gave the idea her **wholehearted support**.”

「她對這個構思給予**全心全意、毫無保留的支持**。」

Practice 19

> “I **wholeheartedly agree** with that point.”

「我**完全／衷心地贊同**那一點。」

wholehearted = 完全真誠、毫無保留地投入或支持的

wholeheartedly = 全心全意地／完全真誠地

10. **heart** = courage / confidence (勇氣) — 勇氣; 信心

A major figurative sense.

Practice 20

> “She found the **heart** to speak in front of the audience.”

「她終於鼓起**勇氣**在觀眾面前發言。」

Practice 21

> “He did not have the **heart** to continue arguing.”

「他已經沒有**心力／勇氣**繼續爭論。」

****heart = 面對困難、恐懼或壓力時所需要的勇氣、精神力量或決心****

11. ****take heart** (振作; 鼓起勇氣) — 振作; 不要灰心**

Practice 22

> “****Take heart****—your presentation is improving.”

「****振作一點／不要灰心****, 你的簡報正在進步。」

Practice 23

> “She ****took heart**** from the positive feedback.”

「正面的回饋令她****增加了信心／振作起來****。」

****take heart = 因某種鼓勵而重新獲得勇氣、希望或信心****

12. ****lose heart** (失去信心／勇氣) — 灰心; 氣餒**

Practice 24

> “Don’t ****lose heart**** after one mistake.”

「不要因為一個錯誤就****灰心／氣餒****。」

Practice 25

> “The team began to ****lose heart**** after several failures.”

「幾次失敗後, 團隊開始****失去信心****。」

****lose heart = 因困難或失敗而失去勇氣、希望或繼續努力的動力****

13. ****have the heart to do something** (忍心／有勇氣做) — 忍心; 有心做**

This construction has an important emotional nuance.

Practice 26

> “I didn’t **have the heart to tell** her the bad news.”

「我**不忍心告訴**她這個壞消息。」

Practice 27

> “How could he **have the heart to** leave them like that?”

「他怎麼**忍心**那樣離開他們？」

have the heart to do something = 有足夠的狠心／勇氣去做一件情感上令人難受的事

In negatives, especially:

> **not have the heart to**

often means:

不忍心

14. **heart** = compassion/kindness (同情心／善心) — 善心; 同情心

Practice 28

> “She has a kind **heart**.”

「她有一顆**善良的心**／很有愛心。」

Practice 29

> “He may seem strict, but he has a good **heart**.”

「他可能看起來嚴厲, 但其實**心地很好**。」

heart = 一個人的善良、同情心或關懷別人的本性

15. **heartless**(無情的) — 無情的; 冷酷的

The negative family member.

Practice 30

> “It would be **heartless** to ignore someone who needs help.”

「對需要幫助的人置之不理會顯得很**無情**。」

Practice 31

> “The decision was criticized as **heartless**.”

「這項決定被批評為**冷酷無情**。」

heartless = 缺乏同情心、關懷或對別人感受的體諒

16. **heart** = centre/core of something(中心) — 中心; 核心

A major figurative spatial meaning.

Meaning: The central, most important, or most active part of something.

Practice 32

> “The hotel is in the **heart of the city**.”

「酒店位於城市的**中心地帶**。」

Practice 33

> “Communication is at the **heart of good teamwork**.”

「溝通是良好團隊合作的**核心**。」

heart of something = 某個地方的中心, 或某件事情最重要、最核心的部分

17. **the heart of a city/area**(市中心/地區中心) — 中心地帶

Practice 34

> “Their office is in the **heart of the business district**.”

「他們的辦公室位於商業區的**中心地帶**。」

Practice 35

> “The restaurant is located in the **heart of London**.”

「這間餐廳位於倫敦**市中心／核心地帶**。」

the heart of a place = 某個地區最中央、最繁忙或最具代表性的部分

18. **at the heart of + issue/system (問題／制度核心) — 核心; 關鍵**

Practice 36

> “Confidence was **at the heart of** the problem.”

「自信問題是整件事的**核心**。」

Practice 37

> “Trust is **at the heart of** a strong working relationship.”

「信任是良好工作關係的**核心要素**。」

at the heart of something = 處於某件事情最重要、最根本或最關鍵的位置

19. **get to the heart of something (深入核心) — 找出核心; 直指問題本質**

Practice 38

> “The question gets to the **heart of the issue**.”

「這個問題**直指問題核心**。」

Practice 39

> “We need to get to the **heart of the problem**.”

「我們需要找出這個問題的**真正核心／根本原因**。」

get to the heart of = 找到某件事情最重要、最根本的部分

20. **heart of the matter**(事情核心) — 問題核心; 事情本質

Practice 40

> “That is the **heart of the matter**.”

「那就是整件事的**核心／本質**。」

Practice 41

> “The debate never reached the **heart of the matter**.”

「辯論一直沒有觸及事情的**核心問題**。」

heart of the matter = 某件事情真正最重要的問題／本質

21. **at heart**(本質上) — 本質上; 內心其實

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 42

> “He seems serious, but he is shy **at heart**.”

「他看起來很嚴肅, 但**骨子裡／本質上**其實很害羞。」

Practice 43

> “She is an optimist **at heart**.”

「她**本質上／內心其實**是一個樂觀的人。」

at heart = 從一個人最真實、最根本的性格或信念來看

22. **take something to heart(把事情放在心上) — 對.....太在意;認真接受**

A very useful expression with two overlapping nuances.

Practice 44

> “Don’t **take the criticism too much to heart**.”

「不要把那些批評**太放在心上**。」

Practice 45

> “She **took his advice to heart** and practised every day.”

「她把他的建議**牢牢記在心裡並認真實行**，每天都練習。」

take something to heart = 對某件事產生深刻情緒反應, 或非常認真地接受其內容

Context determines whether it means:

- * 被批評深深影響;
- * 真正把建議記住並採納。

23. **learn/know something by heart(背熟) — 背誦;熟記**

A very common learner expression.

Practice 46

> “I didn’t want to learn the whole script **by heart**.”

「我不想把整份講稿**逐字背熟**。」

Practice 47

> “She knows the poem **by heart**.”

「她把這首詩**背得滾瓜爛熟**。」

know/learn by heart = 完全記在記憶中, 不需要看文字也能說出來

This is not about emotions or the physical heart.

24. **have your heart set on something (非常想得到／做到) — 一心想; 下定決心要**

Practice 48

> “She had her **heart set on** getting the promotion.”

「她**一心想得到**那次晉升。」

Practice 49

> “He has his **heart set on** studying abroad.”

「他**一心想去海外留學**。」

have your heart set on something = 非常渴望某件事, 並已經把自己的希望／計劃集中在上面

25. **set your heart on something (立志／一心想) — 一心想要; 下定決心**

Practice 50

> “She **set her heart on** becoming a doctor.”

「她**立志／一心想成為**醫生。」

Practice 51

> “Don’t **set your heart on** one option too early.”

「不要太早就**一心只想著**一個選擇。」

set your heart on = 把強烈希望集中在某個目標／結果上

26. **have a change of heart (改變心意) — 改變主意; 改變立場**

Practice 52

> “I almost refused the presentation, but I had a **change of heart**.”

「我本來差點拒絕簡報，但後來**改變了主意**。」

Practice 53

> “The manager had a **change of heart** and approved the plan.”

「經理後來**改變心意**，批准了計劃。」

a change of heart = 對原本的決定、態度或感受產生重要改變

This fits your passage particularly well conceptually.

27. **break someone's heart**(令人心碎) — 令某人極度傷心

Practice 54

> “The news **broke her heart**.”

「這個消息令她**非常傷心／心碎**。」

Practice 55

> “It would **break his heart** to lose the business.”

「失去這盤生意會令他**極度傷心**。」

break someone's heart = 令某人遭受非常深刻的悲傷、失望或情感痛苦

28. **heartbroken**(心碎的) — 極度傷心的

A useful family extension.

Practice 56

> “She was **heartbroken** when the project was cancelled.”

「項目被取消時，她感到**非常傷心／心碎**。」

Practice 57

> “He was **heartbroken** by the news.”

「這個消息令他**悲痛欲絕**。」

heartbroken = 因失去重要的人／事物或受到重大失望而極度悲傷的

29. **heart goes out to someone** (深表同情) — 很同情; 深感關懷

Practice 58

> “My **heart goes out to** everyone affected.”

「我對所有受影響的人**深表同情**。」

Practice 59

> “Our **hearts go out to** the family.”

「我們對這個家庭**深感同情和關懷**。」

your heart goes out to someone = 對某人的困難、悲傷或痛苦產生強烈同情

30. **have someone's best interests at heart** (為某人著想) — 真心為某人好

Practice 60

> “Your supervisor probably had your best interests **at heart**.”

「你的上司可能真的是**為你好／為你的利益著想**。」

Practice 61

> “I know she has my best interests **at heart**.”

「我知道她是真心**為我著想**。」

have someone's interests at heart = 真誠關心某人的利益、福祉或最佳結果

31. **have a heart(有點同情心) — 有點人情;有同情心**

Practice 62

> “**Have a heart**—he’s already apologized.”

「**有點同情心吧／別那麼狠心**，他已經道歉了。」

Practice 63

> “Come on, **have a heart** and give her another chance.”

「拜託，**通融一下／有點人情吧**，再給她一次機會。」

have a heart = 要求某人表現出同情、善意或寬容

Informal.

32. **heart-to-heart(坦誠深入的談話) — 促膝談心;坦誠交流**

A useful compound.

Practice 64

> “I had a **heart-to-heart** with my supervisor.”

「我和上司作了一次**坦誠深入的談話／談心**。」

Practice 65

> “They had a long **heart-to-heart conversation**.”

「他們進行了一次很長的**坦誠交流**。」

heart-to-heart = 雙方坦白分享真正感受、擔憂或私人想法的深入談話

33. **heart and soul(全副心力;核心精神) — 全心全意;核心人物／精神**

This expression has two common uses.

A. Full commitment

> “She put her **heart and soul** into the project.”

「她把**全部心力**都投入這個項目。」

B. Central driving person/spirit

> “He was the **heart and soul** of the team.”

「他是團隊的**核心人物／靈魂人物**。」

heart and soul = 全部情感和精力, 或令某群體充滿活力的核心人物／精神

34. **put your heart into something** (全心投入) — 用心投入; 全力投入

Practice 66

> “I really **put my heart into** preparing the presentation.”

「我真的**很用心／全心投入**準備這次簡報。」

Practice 67

> “If you **put your heart into** it, people can tell.”

「如果你**真心投入**, 別人是感受得到的。」

put your heart into something = 把大量真誠感情、熱誠和努力投入某件事

35. **half-hearted** (不投入的; 勉強的) — 不熱心的; 敷衍的

An important contrastive family extension.

Practice 68

> “He made a **half-hearted attempt** to practise.”

「他只是**敷衍地／不太投入地**嘗試練習。」

Practice 69

> “The apology sounded **half-hearted**.”

「那個道歉聽起來很**敷衍、不太真誠**。」

half-hearted = 缺乏真正熱誠、投入、努力或誠意的

Contrast:

> wholehearted

= 全心全意的

36. **hearty = warm/enthusiastic(熱烈的) — 熱情的; 熱烈的**

A useful but semantically developed family member.

Practice 70

> “The speaker received **hearty applause**.”

「講者獲得**熱烈的掌聲**。」

Practice 71

> “They gave us a **hearty welcome**.”

「他們給了我們**熱情的歡迎**。」

hearty = 真誠、強烈、充滿熱情的

37. **hearty = large/substantial food(豐盛的) — 豐盛的; 份量足的**

A separate common sense of **hearty**.

Practice 72

> “We had a **hearty breakfast** before the event.”

「活動前我們吃了一頓**豐盛的早餐**。」

Practice 73

> “The restaurant serves **hearty meals**.”

「這間餐廳供應**份量足、很飽肚的餐點**。」

hearty food/meal = 份量足、令人飽足、通常較實在的食物／餐點

This should not be confused with emotional **heart**.

38. **heart-shaped** (心形的) — 心形的

A transparent but common compound.

Practice 74

> “She wore a **heart-shaped** necklace.”

「她戴著一條**心形**頸鏈。」

Practice 75

> “The card had a **heart-shaped** design.”

「卡片上有一個**心形圖案**。」

heart-shaped = 形狀像傳統心形符號的

39. **heart** = heart suit in playing cards (紅心) — 紅心

A distinct noun sense.

Practice 76

> “She played the ace of **hearts**.”

「她打出了**紅心 A**。」

Practice 77

> “He needed a **heart** to complete the hand.”

「他需要一張**紅心牌**才能完成這副牌。」

hearts = 撲克牌四種花色之一; 紅心

The singular can refer to one card of that suit.

40. **Hearts = card game (紅心大戰) — Hearts 紙牌遊戲**

A lexicalized game name.

Practice 78

> “We played **Hearts** after dinner.”

「晚飯後我們玩了 **Hearts／紅心大戰**。」

Practice 79

> “Do you know how to play **Hearts**?”

「你會玩 **Hearts** 嗎？」

This is a proper game name, not another core anatomical sense.

Important distinction: **heart vs mind**

This is particularly relevant to your sentence:

> “My **heart** would race, my **mind** would go blank...”

heart

in your sentence = physical bodily reaction

> 心跳加速

mind

= mental thinking/awareness

> 腦袋一片空白

But figuratively:

heart

often represents:

- * feelings;
- * emotion;
- * courage.

mind

often represents:

- * thought;
- * reasoning;
- * memory;
- * decision.

Compare:

> “My **heart** says yes, but my **mind** says no.”

= 我的**感情**想答應, 但我的**理智**告訴我不要。

Important distinction: **heart vs feelings**

feelings

directly means emotions.

heart

is more figurative and expressive when referring to emotions.

> “She hurt my feelings.”

= 她傷害了我的感受。

> “She broke my heart.”

= 她令我非常心碎／傷心。

****Heart**** often sounds emotionally stronger or more metaphorical.

Important distinction: **heart = organ vs heart = emotion**

This is the central polysemy contrast.

Physical:

> “My ****heart**** was beating quickly.”

= 我的****心臟／心跳****很快。

Emotional:

> “I knew it in my ****heart****.”

= 我****內心深處****知道。

Learners need context to decide whether Chinese should be:

* 心臟

* 心跳

* 內心

* 感情

* 勇氣

* 核心

Important distinction: **heart vs core**

Both can mean 「核心」.

core

is neutral and analytical:

> “the core problem”

= 核心問題

heart

is more figurative and often emphasizes central importance:

> “the heart of the problem”

= 問題最核心／最根本的部分

Heart can feel more vivid or expressive.

Important distinction: **heart vs centre/center**

centre

usually means physical/mathematical middle.

heart

can mean:

* central location;

* most important/active central part.

Compare:

> “the geographical centre of the city”

= 城市的地理中心

> “the heart of the city”

= 市中心／最繁華核心地區

These may not refer to exactly the same location.

Important distinction: **learn by heart vs understand**

learn/know by heart

= memorize exactly

It does **not** mean:

> deeply understand emotionally.

> “I know the script by heart.”

= 我把講稿**背熟了**。

You may know something by heart without fully understanding every detail.

Important distinction: **take to heart vs take seriously**

They overlap.

take seriously

= treat something as important/credible.

take to heart

often adds emotional/internal impact:

> criticism affects you deeply

or:

> advice is sincerely accepted.

Compare:

> “Take the warning seriously.”

= 認真看待警告。

> “He took the criticism to heart.”

= 他把批評放在心上，受到很大影響。

Important distinction: **have your heart set on vs plan to**

plan to

= intend to do something.

have your heart set on

= strongly desire one particular outcome.

> “I plan to study abroad.”

= 我計劃留學。

> “I have my heart set on studying abroad.”

= 我一心想去留學，非常渴望。

The second carries much stronger emotion.

Important distinction: **change of heart vs change of mind**

These overlap but have slightly different flavor.

change your mind

= change a decision/opinion.

change of heart

= change your attitude, feeling, or decision, often emotionally.

> “I changed my mind about the date.”

neutral decision

> “He had a change of heart and decided to help.”

often suggests a deeper change in feeling/attitude.

Important distinction: **heartfelt** vs **wholehearted**

heartfelt

focuses on sincerity of **emotion**:

> heartfelt thanks

= 由衷感謝

wholehearted

focuses on complete **commitment/support**:

> wholehearted support

= 全心全意／毫無保留的支持

So:

heartfelt = 情感真摯

wholehearted = 投入／支持完全

Important distinction: **heartless** vs **cold-hearted**

Both mean lacking compassion.

heartless

= generally lacking kindness or compassion.

cold-hearted

often emphasizes emotional coldness or lack of sympathy.

Both are strong negative descriptions.

Important distinction: **heart races vs heart pounds**

heart races

emphasizes:

> fast heartbeat.

heart pounds

emphasizes:

> strong/heavy noticeable beating.

When very nervous, both can happen:

> “My heart was racing and pounding.”

Important distinction: **heart rate vs heartbeat**

heartbeat

= each beat / the sensation or rhythm of the heart beating.

heart rate

= measured number of beats per minute.

So:

> “My heartbeat felt very strong.”

versus:

> “My heart rate was 120 beats per minute.”

Family-extension sweep

The practical **heart** family is especially rich in literal, emotional, spatial, and idiomatic uses:

- * **heart — organ** = 心臟
- * **heart beats/races/pounds** = 心跳／心跳加速
- * **heart rate** = 心率
- * **heart disease/condition** = 心臟疾病
- * **heart — emotions** = 內心／感情
- * **from the heart** = 發自內心
- * **heartfelt** = 由衷／真摯的
- * **with all your heart** = 打從心底／全心全意
- * **wholehearted / wholeheartedly** = 全心全意的／地
- * **heart — courage** = 勇氣／精神力量
- * **take heart** = 振作／增加信心
- * **lose heart** = 灰心
- * **not have the heart to** = 不忍心
- * **heart — compassion** = 善心／同情心
- * **heartless** = 無情的
- * **heart — centre/core** = 中心／核心
- * **heart of a city** = 市中心／核心地帶
- * **at the heart of** = 處於事情核心
- * **heart of the matter** = 事情核心
- * **at heart** = 本質上／內心其實
- * **take something to heart** = 把事情放在心上／認真接受
- * **learn/know by heart** = 背熟
- * **have/set your heart on** = 一心想要／決心追求
- * **change of heart** = 改變心意
- * **break someone's heart** = 令某人心碎
- * **heartbroken** = 極度傷心的
- * **heart goes out to** = 深表同情
- * **have someone's interests at heart** = 真心為某人著想
- * **have a heart** = 有點同情心／通融
- * **heart-to-heart** = 坦誠深入的談話
- * **heart and soul** = 全副心力／核心靈魂人物
- * **put your heart into** = 全心投入
- * **half-hearted** = 敷衍／不投入的
- * **hearty — enthusiastic** = 熱情／熱烈的
- * **hearty — food** = 豐盛、飽肚的
- * **heart-shaped** = 心形的
- * **hearts — cards** = 紅心花色

The main semantic branches are:

> **physical organ**

> **emotions / sincerity**

> **courage / spirit**

> **compassion**

> **centre / core**

plus a particularly rich family of fixed expressions.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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heart — physical organ	位於胸腔內、負責把血液泵送到全身的器官; 心臟
heart races/beats/pounds	心臟跳動速度／力度變得明顯, 尤其因緊張、恐懼、興奮或運動
heart rate	心臟每分鐘跳動的次數; 心率
heart — emotions	一個人的深層感情、情緒或內心感受
from the heart	真誠、發自內心地表達, 而不是例行或虛假的
heartfelt	感情真實而強烈、發自內心的; 由衷的
with all your heart	帶著非常強烈而真誠的感情、意願或投入
wholehearted / wholeheartedly	完全真誠、毫無保留地投入、支持或贊同
heart — courage	面對困難、恐懼或壓力所需要的勇氣、精神力量或決心
take heart	因鼓勵或希望而重新獲得勇氣／信心
lose heart	因困難或失敗而失去勇氣、希望或繼續努力的動力
not have the heart to	因同情、不捨或情感困難而不忍心做某事
heart — compassion	一個人的善良、同情心和關懷別人的本性
heartless	缺乏同情心、關懷或對別人感受的體諒; 無情的
heart — centre/core	某個地方最中央／活躍的部分, 或某件事最重要、最根本的核心
the heart of a place	某個地區最中央、最繁忙或最具代表性的核心地帶
at the heart of	處於某件事情最重要、最根本或最關鍵的位置
heart of the matter	某件事情真正最重要的問題／本質
at heart	從一個人最真實、最根本的性格、信念或傾向來看
take something to heart	深受某事情緒影響, 或非常認真地接受並記住其內容
learn/know by heart	完全背熟, 不需要看文字也能準確說出
have/set your heart on	非常渴望某個特定結果, 並把希望集中在上面
a change of heart	對原來的態度、感受或決定產生重要改變
break someone's heart	令某人遭受非常深刻的悲傷、失望或情感痛苦

heartbroken	因重大失去或失望而極度悲傷的	
heart goes out to someone	對某人的困難、悲傷或痛苦產生強烈同情	
have someone's interests at heart	真誠關心某人的利益、福祉及最佳結果	
have a heart	要求某人表現同情、善意、寬容或通融	
heart-to-heart	雙方坦白分享真正感受、擔憂或私人想法的深入談話	
heart and soul	全部感情和精力;或令某群體充滿活力的核心／靈魂人物	
put your heart into	把大量真誠感情、熱誠和努力投入某件事情	
half-hearted	缺乏真正熱誠、投入、努力或誠意的;敷衍的	
hearty — enthusiastic	真誠、強烈、充滿熱情的	
hearty — food	份量足、實在而令人飽足的	
hearts — playing cards	撲克牌四種花色之一;紅心	

For your original passage

> “My **heart would race**, my mind would go blank, and I would start imagining the worst.”

The exact meaning is:

heart = 身體內負責泵送血液的心臟;這裡特別指緊張時心臟跳動加快的身體反應

Therefore:

> **my heart would race**

= 「我會心跳加速／我的心會跳得很快」

This is a physical sign of your nervousness.

The sentence actually creates a useful body-versus-mind contrast:

> **my heart would race**

> = 身體出現明顯的緊張反應

> **my mind would go blank**

> = 思考突然停止, 腦袋一片空白

So the key mapping in your passage is:

heart = 心臟

heart races = 因緊張、恐懼或興奮而心跳突然加快

The most important learner contrasts are:

> ****my heart is racing****

> = 我心跳很快

> ****in my heart****

> = 在我內心深處

> ****take heart****

> = 振作／鼓起勇氣

> ****lose heart****

> = 灰心

> ****the heart of the city****

> = 市中心／核心地帶

> ****the heart of the problem****

> = 問題核心

> ****learn it by heart****

> = 把它背熟

> ****take criticism to heart****

> = 把批評放在心上

> ****have your heart set on something****

> = 一心想得到／做到某事

> ****a change of heart****

> = 改變心意

> ****heartfelt thanks****

> = 由衷感謝

So ****heart**** is far richer than simply:

> ****heart = 心臟****

but in your original sentence, the correct meaning is very specifically the ****physical heart and its rapid heartbeat caused by nervousness****.